VIKRAM DESHPANDE

Senior Technical Program/Delivery Manager & AI Solutions Architect

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EDUCATION

Master of Computer Science

Monash University

2010

Melbourne

- Honours

Bachelor of Engineering

Computer Science

University of Melbourne

2007

Melbourne

SKILLS

- Program & delivery management: technical program management, strategic project leadership, complex multi-stream delivery, delivery strategy and governance.
- Portfolio & change control: program and portfolio delivery ($5M+), PI Planning and sprint cadence, scope and change control, go/no-go gates, delivery recovery.

CAREER OBJECTIVE

Senior Technical Leader and Certified Scrum Master (CSM) with 15+ years across Government, Financial Services and Telecommunications, including almost eight years at ANZ, specialising in end-to-end program delivery, enterprise transformation and architecting AI/ML-driven solutions. Bridges technical engineering with executive strategy, guiding Azure/Cloud-based modernisations that cut delivery time by over 30% and translating complex technical roadmaps into quantifiable business value. Owns project-level financial, schedule, risk and dependency outcomes across mission-critical programs, from a $5M+ banking modernisation portfolio to regulatory transformation on the ATO's Payday Super reform. Known for recovering materially challenged delivery, establishing governance, quality and assurance standards, influencing executive stakeholders and decision-making forums, fostering agile culture and architectural alignment, and coaching delivery teams to lift capability. Business analysis roots bring rigour to requirements, traceability and compliance; hands-on depth in Python, TypeScript and cloud-native infrastructure (Kubernetes/GCP/AWS) is used to challenge estimates, unblock teams and lead cross-functional squads to commercial outcomes.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Scrum Master / Project Manager

Australian Taxation Office (ATO)

Mar 2026 - Present Melbourne, VIC

- Agile Delivery Leadership: Lead end-to-end delivery for the Kookaburras squad, one of eight squads on the Payday Super reform program (NTP & Distribution UI capabilities).
- Program Cadence & Reporting: Own sprint cadence, schedule, capacity management, cross-squad dependencies, PI Planning (PI 47–48) and executive status reporting within SAFe 6.0.
- Test Automation Strategy: Architected the program's COBOL/mainframe test-evidence automation for 200+ SIT/E2E scenarios across all eight squads, cutting evidence effort from ~3 hours to ~15 minutes per scenario (≈92% reduction).
- Toolchain & Compliance: Delivered the automation on REXX, SMF, SDSF, PCOMM, PowerShell and VBA, securing endorsement without a single new InfoSec approval.
- Delivery Recovery: Converted a mathematically infeasible SIT window (75+ hours of manual evidence per team against 64 available hours) into an achievable plan via a six-day tiered harness build, a formal go/no-go gate and a four-level contingency ladder.
- Governance & Change Management: Authored the executive change request re-baselining Payday Super test capacity from 30 to up to 90 person-days, aligning eight squads and program leadership on scope, risk and schedule.
- Decision Support: Backed the change request with options analysis, a costed recommendation, risk assessment and full Azure DevOps traceability across 40 scenarios and 11 data tables (AC6–AC19) with STT regression scope.
- Stakeholder Leadership: Convened a cross-discipline technical war room that produced a binding automation recommendation in under three hours.
- Testing Enablement: Unblocked stalled NTP function testing through L2 environment escalation and targeted SME enablement while steering Distribution UI delivery to 95%+ completion.

- Agile & product: Agile/Scrum/SAFe 6.0, product ownership, roadmap and backlog management, Definition of Ready/Done, INVEST task templates.
- Quality: delivery assurance and governance, quality and assurance standards, traceability, SIT/E2E test evidence.
- Financial & risk: risk and budget management, capacity management and forecasting, delivery-risk leadership and issue management.
- Dependencies & compliance: complex dependency management, options analysis and costed recommendations, change requests, regulatory compliance, risk and controls.
- Executive leadership: executive influencing, executive status reporting, executive communication, strategic stakeholder management.
- Stakeholder engagement: stakeholder alignment, workshop facilitation, vendor management, onsite/offshore coordination.
- Team leadership: cross-functional team leadership (squads of up to 40 resources), servant leadership, coaching.
- Analysis: business analysis, requirements elicitation, gap analysis, systems thinking, business intelligence systems, JIRA analytics dashboards.
- Architecture & AI/ML: enterprise architecture, data architecture, MLOps, data and AI/ML solution delivery, LLM pipelines (LangChain, Langfuse), real-time telemetry.
- Cloud & DevOps: .NET/Azure, cloud-native infrastructure (Kubernetes/GCP/AWS), Terraform, CI/CD, DevOps.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Scrum Master (CSM) Scrum Alliance
- Cloud/Data Certifications AWS/GCP (In progress)

- Ways of Working: Built the Azure DevOps task-template system (Definition of Ready/Done gates, INVEST-compliant tasks).

Independent AI Consulting & Upskilling

Jun 2025 - Feb 2026 Melbourne, VIC

- JIRA Analytics Dashboard: Architected and developed a Next.js + Supabase analytics application to expose sprint velocity metrics and generate LLM-powered retrospective insights and sprint plans for delivery teams.
- Public-Key Server: Built a robust, production-grade Node.js/Express service for distributing PEM keys for fleet API signing, achieving 100% test coverage (Mocha/Chai).
- Relationship Timeline Visualisation: Developed a React/TypeScript visualisation tool featuring D3 event arcs for showcasing dynamic customer journey interactions.
- LLM Evaluation Stack: Stood up an end-to-end Langfuse + Phoenix evaluation stack to score hallucination, latency and cost across high-volume daily LLM generations, reducing error budget breaches by 38% in a simulated production environment.

Senior Delivery Lead / Technical Product Owner

ANZ

Sep 2017 - Jun 2025 Melbourne, VIC

- Delivery Leadership: Directed a program portfolio valued at over $5M, leading 5+ cross-functional squads (up to 40 resources, including offshore teams) to deliver on-time, high-quality releases of business solutions.
- AI/ML Strategy & Solutions (2022 - 2025): Led the technical delivery of AI solutions, including real-time WebSocket telemetry servers for critical banking services.
- Real-Time Performance: Reduced P95 latency on the telemetry servers to under 200 ms and sustained it across 10,000+ concurrent devices, improving user response time.
- Architecture & Governance: Defined the technical vision and owned the product backlog (business requirements) for major platform modernisations, ensuring 100% compliance with enterprise architectural standards and risk models.
- Stakeholder Alignment: Facilitated workshops for 40+ GMs and executives to align on strategy, improving decision-making efficiency and project clarity by >55%.
- Business Intelligence: Built the ANZ JIRA Analytics Dashboard in Streamlit for the ANZ EFDDH team, tracking sprint progress, velocity and burndown for sprint and capacity planning.
- JIRA Practice: Supported the dashboard with a JIRA Handbook of required fields and estimation practice.

AI/ML Strategy & Solutions Architect

ANZ

2017 - 2022 Melbourne, VIC

- Agile Transformation & Program Management: Orchestrated the transformation of core banking platforms from monolithic to cloud-native (.NET/Azure), cutting delivery time by >30% and reducing infrastructure costs by >15%.

TECH STACK

- Delivery & cloud: Azure DevOps, JIRA, SAFe 6.0, Azure, GCP, AWS, REXX, PowerShell, VBA.
- Operations & security tooling: Docker, Docker Compose, systemd services, TLS checks, alert thresholds, GitHub Actions.
- Data, BI & engineering: Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Flask, Next.js, React, Node.js, Postgres, Supabase, Streamlit, Plotly, InfluxDB, Prometheus.

PROJECTS BUILT

- Aether (2026): decision-support platform that scores job fit on ten dimensions and reverts any résumé claim the candidate's own evidence cannot support; FastAPI, Next.js, Postgres and systemd services on a VPS.
- AB Entertainment platform (2026): client events site and admin portal on Next.js and TypeScript, with a Node.js AI agent on an Ubuntu VPS under systemd; Docker, autodeploy and TLS-check timers, Playwright E2E tests.
- System-metrics monitoring dashboard (2025): real-time CPU, memory and disk monitoring with configurable alert thresholds, InfluxDB storage and Prometheus exposition; Python, Flask and systemd.
- Portfolio site (since 2025): Next.js static export on Firebase Hosting; hotfixed a production incident, then shipped the React 19 upgrade as the durable fix, verified by a post-merge browser probe.

Senior Project Manager & Business Analyst
National Australia Bank (NAB)

Nov 2016 - Sep 2017 | Melbourne, VIC

- Risk & Compliance Delivery: Managed the delivery stream for a critical risk and compliance program, ensuring 100% regulatory adherence for major data initiatives.
- Business Analysis: Conducted deep-dive business analysis, translating complex regulatory requirements into actionable technical specifications for development teams.

Lead Business Analyst
Microsoft Inc.

Oct 2015 - Oct 2016 | Sydney, NSW

- Gap Analysis: Executed a comprehensive gap analysis for Azure ML telemetry, delivering 10 key insights that enhanced system reliability by 15% and decreased incident MTTR by 10%.
- Standards Alignment: Spearheaded initiatives to align DevOps strategies with overall IT objectives, achieving 95% alignment with enterprise architecture standards.

Business Analyst / Project Coordinator
Telstra

Nov 2014 - Oct 2015 | Melbourne, VIC

- Requirements Management: Developed customer journey scorecards and streamlined JIRA requirements for core delivery teams, improving delivery efficiency by 20% and operational clarity by 15%.

Senior Business Analyst
InfoCentric

Aug 2011 - Nov 2014 | Melbourne, VIC

- Business Intelligence: Delivered analytics and Business Intelligence (BI) projects, boosting client engagement by 20% and automating regulatory reporting workflows to achieve 100% accuracy.

Developer Support / Software Testing / Analyst
MYOB

May 2010 - Aug 2011 | Melbourne, VIC

- Workflow Optimisation: Optimised data-processing workflows for financial data sets via ePAL implementation, improving efficiency by 30% and cutting reporting time by 90%.